



Electrician

electrician • 4-5 year apprenticeship

\$60K-\$80K / yr

THE TRADE

Install, maintain, and repair the electrical systems that power homes, businesses, and industrial facilities. Electricians build everything on the National Electrical Code (NEC), troubleshoot live systems safely, and stay in demand nationwide — the highest-paying licensed trade on the TradeLift board.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$60K-\$80K

BLS median \$61,590 (blog-cited) • apprentice 4-5 yr, ~8,000 OJT hrs • top licensed trade on the TradeLift board

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



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CERTIFICATIONS — FIRST 12 WEEKS

REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 10 Hour — the universal entry credential

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm **trade fit**
- ☐ Verify your OSHA 10 online (a few days)
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call your local IBEW hall for deadline
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov electrician
- ☐ Ask a working electrician 5 questions
- ☐ Buy basics: multimeter, wire strippers
- ☐ Study NEC article 90 before intake
- ☐ Apply to 3 apprenticeships or programs
- ☐ Prep for the apprentice aptitude test
- ☐ Shadow a helper shift if you can

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>